KEEPING IT REAL

27.4% OF SELLERS CUT PRICE IN SEPTEMBER.

Zillow says that's up from 26.2% a year ago.

D.J. Paris
Keeping It Real Podcast

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NEWLY SIGNED DEALS JUST FELL 8.5% FROM LAST YEAR.

Zillow's own chief economist expects sales to stay below last year's pace through December.

A SELLER WHO ALREADY CUT PRICE ALREADY SAID YES TO LESS.

Zillow's September 2026 Market Report: 27.4% of listings had a price cut, up from 26.2% a year earlier and 26.3% in August. Newly pending sales fell 8.5% year over year, and mortgage rates ended the month at 7.28%, the highest reading since November 2023, according to Freddie Mac. Zillow chief economist Mischa Fisher: "We expect sales to remain lower than last year through the fourth quarter." Your buyer still thinks the asking price is the only number that matters. A seller who already reduced once has already shown they'll take less than they first asked for.

WHAT YOU DO DIFFERENTLY ON THE NEXT OFFER:

1 **Pull the price history before you write anything.**

A cut once means there's room to ask for more.

2 **Point your buyer toward homes that already reduced.**

Those sellers already said yes to less, in writing.

3 **Bring up the rate, not just the price.**

At 7.28%, a lower purchase price can offset a higher monthly payment.

4 **Tell your buyer a full-price offer isn't required right now.**

More than one in four sellers nationally already proved it.

THE TAKEAWAY

A SELLER WHO CUT ONCE ALREADY SAID YES TO LESS.

Pull the price history before you write the next offer.

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